

Counterinsurgency Vehicles

Conventional vehicles are generally low to the ground with lightly armored undersides, leaving them vulnerable to landmines. During the 1970s, the increasing use of such weapons by insurgents and terrorist organizations led to the development of armored vehicles specifically designed to protect against mines. Rhodesia (modern-day Zimbabwe) was the first to encounter this problem; its solution was to protect the crew compartment by raising it higher and angling the underside to deflect the blast—so the vehicle might lose a wheel, but the crew would survive.

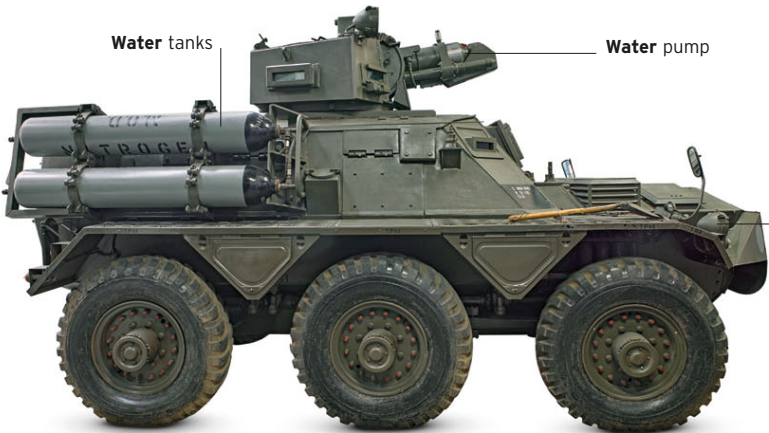


△ **Humber "Pig"**
Date 1958 **Country** UK
Weight 6.4 tons (5.8 tonnes)
Engine Rolls-Royce B60 Mk 5A gasoline, 120 hp
Main armament None

Designed as an eight-man armored personnel carrier, the Pig was hastily given extra armor and brought back into service as the conflict in Northern Ireland worsened. Some Pigs were modified for specialist roles, and the vehicle was used into the 1990s.

▷ **Shorland Mark 1**
Date 1965 **Country** UK
Weight 3.5 tons (3.1 tonnes)
Engine Rover 4 cylinder gasoline, 67 hp
Main armament 7.62 mm machine gun

Used by the Royal Ulster Constabulary and Ulster Defence Regiment, the Shorland Mark 1 was based on the Land Rover Series IIA chassis. The armored body was topped with a machine-gun turret. Successive upgrades improved the armor and engine power, with the final versions being based on the more modern Land Rover Defender's chassis.



△ **Saracen Special Water Dispenser**
Date 1972 **Country** UK
Weight 15 tons (13.7 tonnes)
Engine Rolls-Royce B80 Mk 6A gasoline, 160 hp
Main armament Water cannon

The Saracen was equipped with a water cannon originally intended for riot control. Tests showed that the water cannon was powerful enough to seriously injure people hit by it, so it was instead used for Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD). The water was powerful enough to break up bombs without detonating them.



▷ **Casspir**
Date 1979 **Country** South Africa
Weight 12 tons (10.9 tonnes)
Engine Mercedes-Benz OM-352A diesel, 166 hp
Main armament None

Designed for the South African Police, who were involved in both riot control and fighting in the Border War, the Casspir had an enclosed armored body and windows. It could carry 12 passengers. This versatile vehicle was put to a range of uses including mine clearance, recovery, mortar carrier, and tanker.



◁ **Buffel**
Date 1978 **Country** South Africa
Weight 6.7 tons (6.1 tonnes)
Engine Mercedes-Benz OM-352 diesel, 125 hp
Main armament None

The Buffel's chassis and engine came from the Unimog truck, and the mine-resistant crew pod was open-topped, giving the 10 passengers an excellent field of view. The V-shaped floor deflected the blast away from the passengers, and the water-filled tires helped dissipate it further. Buffels were used by the South African Army until the 1990s.

